

PHAR6302: Advanced Clinical Management of Chronic and Complex Conditions

Online

Semester 2 - 2026



THE UNIVERSITY OF
NEWCASTLE
AUSTRALIA

OVERVIEW

Course Description

This course is designed to equip pharmacists with the advanced knowledge, skills, and professional behaviours necessary to prescribe safely and effectively for chronic and complex conditions within the scope of practice of a pharmacist. Building on prior pharmacotherapy and prescribing foundations, students will apply clinical reasoning and evidence-based practice to real-world prescribing scenarios across these therapeutic areas. The course emphasises competence in patient assessment, therapeutic decision-making, and the full prescribing process - including medicine selection, monitoring, and review. A strong focus is placed on patient-centred care, interprofessional collaboration, and the ethical, legal, and regulatory frameworks that govern pharmacist prescribing practice in Australia. Through a blend of case-based learning, simulation, and applied assessment, students will develop and demonstrate advanced clinical management capability in alignment with contemporary pharmacist scopes of practice.

Requisites

Program Enrolment Rule:
Available to students in the following program(s):
Graduate Certificate in Pharmacist Prescribing and Advanced Practice [50097]

Assumed Knowledge

Some skills in health assessment and clinical decision making. Ability to justify clinical decision making. Ability to access and evaluate information from a variety of sources.

Contact Hours

Online Activity

Online

4 hour(s) per week(s) for 12 week(s) starting Week 1

Self-Directed Learning

Self-Directed

4 hour(s) per week(s) for 12 week(s) starting Week 1

Tutorial Online

6 x 1 hour per fortnight

Unit Weighting

10

Workload

Students are required to spend on average 120-140 hours of effort (contact and non-contact) including assessments per 10 unit course.

COURSE OUTLINE

www.newcastle.edu.au

CRICOS Provider 00109J

CONTACTS

Course Coordinator	Online Kristin Xenos Kristin.Xenos@newcastle.edu.au (02) 4055 0296 Consultation: By email
	A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin Sarah.DineenGriffin@newcastle.edu.au Consultation: By email
Teaching Staff	Other teaching staff will be advised on the course Canvas site.
School Office	School of Biomedical Sciences and Pharmacy MS607 Medical Sciences Building, Callaghan Biomedsci-Admin@newcastle.edu.au 02 49212058 or 49212008 8:30am – 5:00pm (Mon – Fri)

SYLLABUS

Course Content	1. Clinical Application of Assessment Skills 2. Advanced Therapeutic Reasoning and Decision-Making 3. Complex Case Management and Comorbidity Considerations 4. Safe Prescribing and Interprofessional Communication 5. Collaborative Prescribing and Interprofessional Communication 6. Professional Identity, Accountability, and Reflective Practice in Scope
Course Learning Outcomes	On successful completion of this course, students will be able to: 1. Conduct focussed clinical assessments of chronic and complex conditions within the pharmacist's prescribing scope and develop evidence-based management plans to optimise patient outcomes. 2. Apply clinical reasoning, evidence-based guidelines, and therapeutic knowledge to develop safe and effective prescribing plans for chronic and complex conditions. 3. Make prescribing decisions that uphold patient-centred care, addressing individual needs, preferences, health literacy, and supporting shared decision-making in the management of relevant chronic and complex conditions. 4. Evaluate treatment outcomes for chronic and complex conditions and adjust therapy as needed by monitoring effectiveness, identifying and managing adverse effects, safety concerns, and medicine interactions within the pharmacist's prescribing scope. 5. Communicate prescribing decisions clearly and collaboratively with patients, carers, and other health professionals to ensure safe, coordinated, and integrated care for a range of chronic and complex conditions. 6. Reflect critically on prescribing practice, demonstrating accountability, commitment to quality improvement, and readiness for prescribing in the context of chronic and complex conditions.
Course Materials	Texts and material will be available online; links will be provided via Canvas and/or access via the library

COMPULSORY REQUIREMENTS

In order to pass this course, each student must complete ALL of the following compulsory requirements:

Course Assessment Requirements:

- Assessment 2 - Chronic Condition Action Plan and Viva Voce: Pass requirement - Must pass this assessment item to pass the course.
- Assessment 3 - Interprofessional Handover and Documentation: Submit assessment item - Must submit this assessment to pass the course.

SCHEDULE

Date	Day	Time	Location	Topic	Lecturer
Week 1 17 Aug					
Cardiovascular Disease			Foundations of cardiovascular risk assessment and chronic disease management; Identification of modifiable and non-modifiable risk factors; Application of absolute cardiovascular risk tools; Developing patient-centred management plans; Initiating lifestyle and pharmacological strategies; Documentation of clinical reasoning and decisions		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			Tutorial 1: Tuesday 18 August 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm		
Week 2 24 Aug					
Cardiovascular Assessment, Hypertension			Conducting focused cardiovascular assessment; Applying guideline-directed treatment thresholds; Collaborative initiation and titration of antihypertensive therapies; Monitoring efficacy and safety; Identifying contraindications and drug interactions; Supporting adherence and lifestyle modification; Providing clear safety-netting and referral		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			No tutorial this week		
Week 3 31 Aug					
Diabetes & Dyslipidaemia			Comprehensive assessment of diabetes including screening, diagnostics, and glycaemic and lipid targets; Applying stepwise pharmacotherapy for type 2 diabetes and dyslipidaemia; Individualising therapy based on patient factors and comorbidities; Monitoring glycaemic control, complications and adverse effects; Supporting self-management and adherence; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			Tutorial 2: Tuesday 1 September 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm		
Week 4 7 Sep					
Weight Management			Assessment of overweight and obesity including BMI, waist circumference, and risk stratification; Developing individualised weight management plans; Applying behavioural and lifestyle interventions; Initiating and monitoring pharmacotherapy where appropriate within scope of practice; Addressing weight stigma and supporting patient-centred care; Monitoring outcomes and safety; Providing clear referral pathways		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			No tutorial this week		
Week 5 14 Sep					
Smoking, Vaping and Nicotine Dependence			Assessment of nicotine dependence and readiness to quit; Applying behavioural change frameworks and motivational interviewing; Selection and prescribing of nicotine replacement therapy and pharmacotherapy; Managing withdrawal and relapse prevention, including for vapes; Supporting adherence and follow-up; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			Tutorial 3: Wednesday 16 September 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm		
Week 6 21 Sep					
Respiratory Assessment & COPD			Conducting focused respiratory assessment; Assessing COPD severity; Initiating and optimising inhaled therapies; Teaching inhaler technique and adherence strategies; Monitoring disease progression and exacerbations; Supporting self-management plans; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance		Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
			No tutorial this week		
Recess Break 28 September – 2 October					

Week 7 5 Oct		
Asthma	Assessment of asthma control and severity; Identifying triggers and risk factors for exacerbations; Applying stepwise guideline-directed therapy including inhaled preventers and relievers; Monitoring control and collaboratively adjusting therapy; Teaching inhaler technique and action plans; Supporting adherence and self-management; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	No tutorial this week	
Week 8 12 Oct		
Mental Health	Conducting focused mental health assessment; Appreciating the intersection of mental health with other chronic conditions; Supporting adherence and shared decision-making; Communicating sensitively with patients; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	Tutorial 4: Tuesday 13 October 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm	
Week 9 19 Oct		
Opioid dependence	Assessment of opioid dependence and withdrawal; Applying harm minimisation principles; Opioid substitution therapy including long-acting injectable buprenorphine formulations; Naloxone for overdose prevention; Monitoring adherence and treatment response; Managing stigma and supporting person-centred care; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	No tutorial this week	
Week 10 26 Oct		
Injectable Medicines and Pharmacist Administration	Principles of injectable medication administration including needle length and gauge selection, injection techniques, and site selection; Patient assessment for safe administration and identification of contraindications; Preparation and handling of injectable medicines; Administration of pharmacist-deliverable non-travel vaccines including pneumococcal, shingles, and RSV; Monitoring for and managing adverse events; Documentation and post-administration care; Providing clear patient counselling and safety-netting advice	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	Tutorial 5: Tuesday 27 October 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm	
Week 11 2 Nov		
Travel Health	Conducting pre-travel risk assessment including destination, duration, and individual risk factors; Recommending and prescribing travel vaccines and prophylactic medications; Managing common travel-related conditions; Providing advice on preventive strategies; Monitoring for adverse effects; Delivering patient-centred travel counselling; Providing clear safety-netting and referral guidance	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	No tutorial this week	
Week 12 9 Nov		
Oral Health	Conducting structured oral health assessment including patient history, dental history, and risk factor evaluation; Performing visual screening (e.g., "lift the lip" technique) to identify early signs of tooth decay, gum disease, infection, and oral pathology; Consideration of risk levels and appropriate management pathways; Applying principles of preventive care including patient selection and application of fluoride; Providing evidence-based oral health advice including oral hygiene practices and fluoride use; Identifying red flags requiring urgent or routine referral; Delivering patient-centred education, follow-up, and safety-netting advice	Kristin Xenos A/Prof Sarah Dineen-Griffin
	Tutorial 6: Tuesday 10 November 2026 7:30pm-8:30pm	

ASSESSMENTS

This course has 3 assessments. Each assessment is described in more detail in the sections below.

	Assessment Name	Due Date	Involvement	Weighting	Learning Outcomes
1	Module Quiz	Weeks 4 and 8	Individual	20%	1, 2, 3, 4
2	Chronic Condition Action Plan and Viva Voce*	Friday 25 September 2026 11:59pm (Week 6) (Written Submission) Oral Viva Voce Week 10 at a date/time to be advised	Individual	50%	1, 2, 3, 4, 5
3	Interprofessional Handover and Documentation*	Friday 23 October 2026 11:59pm (Week 9)	Individual	30%	3, 4, 5, 6

* This assessment has a compulsory requirement.

Late Submissions

The mark for an assessment item submitted after the designated time on the due date, without an approved extension of time, will be reduced by up to 10% of the possible maximum mark for that assessment item for each day or part day that the assessment item is late. Note: this applies equally to week and weekend days.

Assessment 1 - Module Quiz

Assessment Type	Quiz
Description	In Term Tests (Individual)
Weighting	20% (10% weighting per quiz)
Due Date	During Week 4 and Week 8 of Semester at a date/time to be advised.
Submission Method	Online via Canvas
Assessment Criteria	Online multiple-choice questions to assess content relevant to course modules. Further details will be provided during the Semester.
Return Method	Completed Online via Canvas
Feedback Provided	Generalised feedback will be provided.
Opportunity to Reattempt	Students will not be given the opportunity to reattempt this assessment.

Assessment 2 - Chronic Condition Action Plan and Viva Voce

Assessment Type	Written Assignment (Individual) and Oral Viva Voce
Description	Written chronic condition action plan and oral viva voce. More information will be provided online via Canvas during Semester
Weighting	50% (20% Written Assignment; 30% Oral Viva Voce)
Compulsory Requirements	Pass Requirement - Must pass this assessment item to pass the course.
Due Date	Friday 25 September 2026 11:59pm (Week 6) (Written Submission) Oral Viva Voce Week 10 at a date/time to be advised
Submission Method	Completed online via Canvas
Assessment Criteria	Students are required to submit a chronic condition action plan relevant to their scope of practice. The written response will form the foundation for an oral viva voce. During the viva voce, students will complete an oral examination with assessors. Further details, including guidance on topic selection and viva voce preparation, will be provided during the Semester.
Return Method	Marked written responses will be returned.
Feedback Provided	Online / email
Opportunity to Reattempt	Students may be given the opportunity to reattempt either component of this assessment.
Use of AI Tools	AI tools are not permitted to be used for this assessment.

Assessment 3 - Interprofessional Handover and Documentation

Assessment Type	Interprofessional handover using ISBAR and critical reflection
Description	Written handover for a chronic condition case. More information will be provided online via Canvas during Semester.
Weighting	30%

Compulsory Requirements	Submit assessment item - Must submit this assessment to pass the Course.
Due Date	Friday 23 October 2026 11:59pm (Week 9)
Submission Method	Completed online via Canvas
Assessment Criteria	Students are required to submit an interprofessional handover for a patient with a chronic condition relevant to their scope of practice. Further details will be provided during the Semester.
Return Method	Marked written responses will be returned.
Feedback Provided	Online / email
Opportunity to Reattempt	Students will not be given the opportunity to reattempt this assessment.
Use of AI Tools	Students may use approved generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools to assist with drafting, editing, proofreading, and improving the clarity of their written communication. AI tools may also be used to support reflective writing by assisting with grammar, structure, and expression. AI tools must not be used to generate the clinical content, prescribing decisions, ISBAR handover, or professional judgement that forms the basis of the assessment. Students are responsible for ensuring the accuracy, appropriateness, and originality of all submitted work and must critically review and verify any AI-generated content before submission. Students must acknowledge any use of AI tools in accordance with University requirements. Any use of AI beyond the permitted scope may constitute a breach of the University's Academic Integrity and Ethical Academic Conduct Policy.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Grading Scheme

This course is graded as follows:

Range of Marks	Grade	Description
85-100	High Distinction (HD)	Outstanding standard indicating comprehensive knowledge and understanding of the relevant materials; demonstration of an outstanding level of academic achievement; mastery of skills*; and achievement of all assessment objectives.
75-84	Distinction (D)	Excellent standard indicating a very high level of knowledge and understanding of the relevant materials; demonstration of a very high level of academic ability; sound development of skills*; and achievement of all assessment objectives.
65-74	Credit (C)	Good standard indicating a high level of knowledge and understanding of the relevant materials; demonstration of a high level of academic achievement; reasonable development of skills*; and achievement of all learning outcomes.
50-64	Pass (P)	Satisfactory standard indicating an adequate knowledge and understanding of the relevant materials; demonstration of an adequate level of academic achievement; satisfactory development of skills*; and achievement of all learning outcomes.
0-49	Fail (FF)	Failure to satisfactorily achieve learning outcomes. If all compulsory course components are not completed the mark will be zero. A fail grade may also be awarded following disciplinary action.

*Skills are those identified for the purposes of assessment task(s).

Communication Methods

Communication methods used in this course include:

- Canvas Course Site: Students will receive communications via announcements on the Canvas course site.
- Email: Students will receive communications via their student email account.

Course Evaluation

Each year feedback is sought from students and other stakeholders about the courses offered in the University for the purposes of identifying areas of excellence and potential improvement.

Learning Analytics

The University uses an evidence-based approach to enhancing student learning and delivering support. Our careful analysis of data through learning analytics informs decision making processes related to student learning, academic outcomes, and support services. Learning analytics may be used to identify targeted individual opportunities for additional support services or interventions.

Interviews on Assessment Items	An Interview may be conducted on any assessment item in this course, in accordance with the Interview on Assessment Items Procedure . The purpose of the interview is to verify the author of the material submitted in response to the assessment task and provide a quality assurance measure. In the event the Course Coordinator is not satisfied that a student's oral responses are consistent with the work originally submitted, the matter will be referred to the Student Academic Conduct Officer, who will take appropriate action under the Student Conduct Rule .
Academic Integrity and Ethical Academic Conduct Policy	All students are required to meet the academic integrity standards of the University. These standards reinforce the importance of integrity and honesty in an academic environment. Academic Integrity policies apply to all students of the University in all modes of study and in all locations. Please refer to the Academic Integrity and Ethical Academic Conduct Policy
Adverse Circumstances	The University acknowledges the right of students to seek consideration for the impact of allowable adverse circumstances that may affect their performance in assessment item(s). Applications for special consideration due to adverse circumstances will be made using the online Adverse Circumstances system where: 1. the assessment item is a major assessment item; or 2. the assessment item is a minor assessment item and the Course Co-ordinator has specified in the Course Outline that students may apply the online Adverse Circumstances system; 3. you are requesting a change of placement; or 4. the course has a compulsory attendance requirement. Before applying you must refer to the Adverse Circumstance Affecting Assessment Items Procedure.
Use of generative artificial intelligence in course assessments	It is critical that any work submitted for assessment is your own original work. Before using generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot, etc) in any assessable work you must ensure that such use is in line with the requirements for the course and expectations of your Course Coordinator. Misuse of AI tools may be considered a breach of the University's Student Conduct Rule and could result in disciplinary action. Artificial Intelligence detection software may be used to review any work you submit. If you have used AI in any way other than has been expressly permitted by your course coordinator, you may be engaging in academic misconduct and be subject to penalties. For information, refer to: • Generative AI Tools • Academic Integrity
Important Policy Information	The Help button in the Canvas Navigation menu contains helpful information for using the Learning Management System. Students should familiarise themselves with the policies and procedures at https://www.newcastle.edu.au/current-students/respect-at-uni/policies-and-procedures that support a safe and respectful environment at the University

This course outline was approved by the Head of School. No alteration of this course outline is permitted without Head of School approval. If a change is approved, students will be notified and an amended course outline will be provided in the same manner as the original.

© 2026 The University of Newcastle, Australia